ProFilm Meter

Professional Film Photography Light Meter & Director's Viewfinder

USER MANUAL · VERSION 4.16.20

Version 4.16.20 · Professional Film Photography Light Meter & Director's Viewfinder

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1. Getting Started

FIRST LAUNCH

The first launch opens a five-step guide to the main controls, camera permission, and key settings. You can open it again from **Settings → Help / Manual**.

CAMERA PERMISSION

The app requires camera access to meter light and display the viewfinder. When prompted, tap **Allow**. If you denied permission, go to your device's Settings app → Privacy → Camera → ProFilm Meter and re-enable it.

NAVIGATION

The app has **three tabs across the top** of the screen. Tap any tab label to switch:

- **Meter** — the main light meter and viewfinder screen
- **Journal** — your saved exposure log
- **Settings** — all configuration options

The active tab is highlighted in amber with an underline. There is no bottom navigation bar and no gear icon shortcut — Settings is always reached by tapping the Settings tab.

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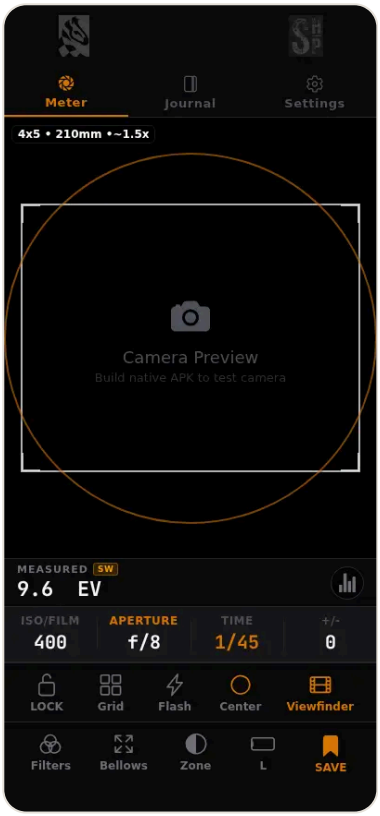
2. The Meter Screen

The Meter screen is where you do most of your work. From top to bottom:

These are genuine app captures from the seeded web preview. The browser does not provide live camera imagery or live metering, so the preview and exposure readout shown here are illustrative; use the installed app for real readings.

VIEWFINDER AREA

The live camera preview with overlaid frame lines, histogram, and status badges. Shows the scene as your film camera would frame it.



(Example) Meter screen from the web preview. The camera image and reading are not live.

EV DISPLAY

The large centre readout shows the current **Exposure Value (EV)**. This updates continuously from the live camera feed.

- **Measured** — the raw metered EV before any compensation
- After locking, the display freezes and the calculated settings are shown

STATUS ROW

A horizontal row of coloured chips showing active features:

- **RECIP** (teal) — reciprocity failure is active and exceeds the threshold
- **FLASH** — flash peak is held
- **+Xmm** — bellows extra extension is active (number shows the mm entered)
- **ENV** — environmental compensation is active
- **SPECTRAL** — spectral sensitivity correction is being applied
- **SW** — software estimation is active (see Calibration section)
- **+/−** — manual exposure compensation is set

CONTROL BAR

A horizontal row of four tappable values sits between the EV display and the status row:

- **ISO/Film** — your film speed and active film stock
- **Aperture** — your f-stop (shown in amber when calculated, or red when outside the selected gear range)
- **Time** — your exposure time (shown in amber when calculated, or red when outside the selected gear range)
- **Comp** — manual exposure compensation (shown in amber when non-zero)

Tap any value to open its selector. For **Aperture**, **Time**, and **Comp**, a bottom sheet slides up with a vertical scroll-wheel dial. The selected value is highlighted in amber at the centre of the wheel.

The ISO/Film button opens a two-tab picker:

- **ISO tab** — scroll-wheel dial for choosing your film speed
- **Film Stock tab** — browse and select a film stock; your **Preferred Setups** appear at the top for one-tap recall, followed by the full stock list

Using the dial:

- **Scroll up or down** within the wheel to move through values — it snaps to the nearest stop
- **Tap the ↑ arrow** at the top of the wheel to step one stop up
- **Tap the ↓ arrow** at the bottom of the wheel to step one stop down
- **Tap any visible value** to jump straight to it
- Each step triggers a light haptic tap

The step size for aperture and shutter is controlled by **Stop Increment** in Settings → Metering. When multiple increments are active, the wheel shows the merged set.

LOCK BUTTON

Tap **LOCK** to freeze the current reading. On iOS and Android, the viewfinder is replaced by a captured still image while the live EV and calculated settings stay fixed. On web, only the reading is locked. Tap **UNLOCK** to resume live metering and preview.

When locked:

- Reciprocity correction is calculated and shown in teal above the shutter value
- When the displayed locked duration exceeds 1 second, a **Timer** chip appears at the bottom of the viewfinder. It uses the reciprocity-corrected duration when correction is active. Tap it to open the Countdown Timer.

SAVE BUTTON

Tap **SAVE** to log the current reading to the Field Journal. The confirmation screen lets you add notes and attach the viewfinder photo.

BOTTOM BUTTONS

Two rows of icon buttons run below the control bar and status chips.

Row 1:

- **Lock** — freeze / unfreeze the current reading
- **Grid** — cycle through viewfinder grid overlays (None → Rule of Thirds → Golden Ratio → Crosshair)
- **Flash** — arm/disarm flash metering (long-press to disarm)
- **Metering Mode** — cycle through Spot, Center-Weighted, and Average
- **Viewfinder / Format** (film icon) — open the lens and format picker sheet

Row 2:

- **Filters** — open the lens filter sheet
- **Bellows** — toggle bellows compensation on/off and enter extra extension beyond the focal length in mm
- **Zone System** — open the zone placement sheet (visible when Zone System is enabled in Settings → Preferences → App Tools Configuration)
- **Film Frame Orientation / Multi-Point** — change the simulated film frame between portrait and landscape, or add a point reading when multi-point is enabled
- **Save** — log the current reading to the Field Journal

When the phone is in landscape with **Allow Screen Rotation** enabled, Meter, Journal, and Settings move to a side rail, and the meter toolbar moves to the opposite rail. The ISO, aperture, shutter, and compensation controls stay interactive in a strip along the bottom of the viewfinder. Toolbar button order and feature availability are unchanged. **Save** uses the normal Journal confirmation flow and attaches the captured viewfinder image when the camera capture succeeds.

3. Metering Modes

Switch metering modes by tapping the **Metering Mode** button. In portrait it appears in the first toolbar row; in landscape it appears in the meter-controls rail. Each tap cycles through Spot, Center-Weighted, and Average.

SPOT

Measures a small circle in the centre of the frame. Use for precise readings of a specific tone — a face, a shadow, a highlight. The spot area size is adjustable in **Settings → Metering → Spot Metering Size**.

> **Note:** *In spot mode, a* **Scan Scene** *button appears next to the Spectral badge — tap it to lock the spectral correction to your exact spot. For RA4 color analysis, spot metering is not recommended — use center-weighted or average for reliable color temperature readings.*

CENTER-WEIGHTED

Prioritises the centre of the frame while still considering the edges. Mimics the behavior of traditional in-camera meters. Area size is adjustable in **Settings → Metering → Center-Weighted Size**.

AVERAGE

Reads the entire frame evenly. Best for scenes with consistent, even lighting. The area size controls how much of the centre is emphasised vs. the full frame average (**Settings → Metering → Average Metering Size**).

ZONE SYSTEM

Access: Enable it in **Settings → Preferences → App Tools Configuration → Zone System**, then show it in **Settings → Metering → Zone System**. Tap the **Zone System button** (contrast icon) in the bottom toolbar to open the placement sheet.

Applies Ansel Adams-style zone placement to the meter — place a specific tone at a specific zone and the meter adjusts exposure accordingly. You can also add or reposition its button in **Settings → Preferences → Customize Toolbar**.

Workflow:

1. Tap the Zone System button on the Meter screen
2. A bottom sheet slides up showing the zone strip and options
3. Choose **Single** or **2-Point** placement, then tap the zone you want to target
4. Point at the area you want to place and tap **Lock** — the meter reads that zone and calculates the EV adjustment needed. In 2-Point mode, lock the shadow and highlight readings independently.
5. The Zone System button shows the current adjustment (e.g. **+2** or **−1**) so you always know it's active
6. The meter automatically switches to **Spot mode** while Zone System is active
7. Tap **Clear** in the sheet to remove the placement and return to normal metering

The EV adjustment from zone placement is added to your exposure in the same way as manual compensation. Zone system data is saved with each journal entry.

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4. Priority Modes

Priority mode is set automatically by which value you tap in the Control Bar:

ACTION	MODE SET	WHAT IS CALCULATED
Tap **Aperture** in the control bar	Aperture Priority	Shutter speed (amber, or red outside gear range)
Tap **Time** in the control bar	Shutter Priority	Aperture (amber, or red outside gear range)

The calculated value updates live as you change the fixed value. Amber means the meter calculated the value. Red means the theoretical ideal is outside the selected gear's supported range; it remains visible for reference, while a saved Journal entry uses the nearest supported setting. Shutter recommendations use one source at a time: mechanical lens marks, a custom shutter preset, or a rolling-shutter profile. Choosing a competing source asks you to switch rather than combining their speeds.

5. Multi-Point Metering

Take several readings and combine them into one exposure value. This is useful in mixed light when you want to balance highlights and shadows.

To enable: Settings → Metering → Multi-Point Metering. Choose how many points to collect (2–4).

Workflow:

1. Enable multi-point and set the count.
2. On the meter screen, point at your first subject and tap to record that EV.
3. Move to each subsequent area and tap again.
4. Once all points are collected, the meter locks automatically and shows the averaged EV.

In the Field Journal, tap the multi-point chip on any saved entry to expand an inline panel showing the individual EV recorded at each point (P1, P2, P3 …).

6. Viewfinder

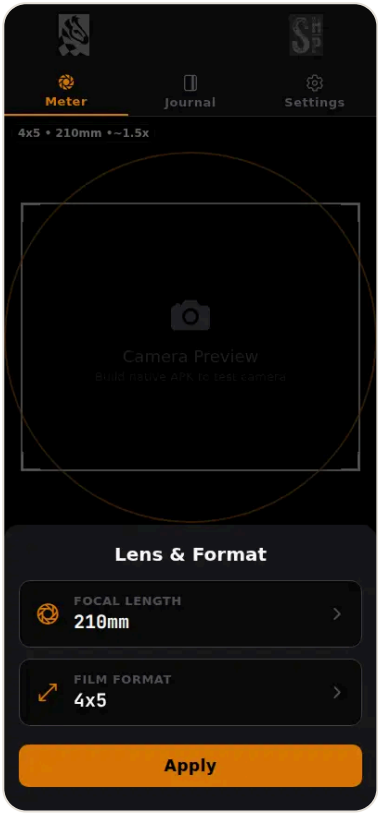
The viewfinder shows the field of view of your film camera based on the selected format and focal length.

FILM FORMAT

Tap the **film icon button** (Viewfinder/Format) in the bottom bar row 1. A sheet opens with two options — tap **Film Format**. A vertical scroll-wheel dial lists all your enabled formats. Scroll to the one you want and it is selected immediately. The viewfinder frame lines scale to match the aspect ratio. Manage available formats in **Settings → Gear Management → Formats**.

FOCAL LENGTH

Tap the **film icon button** (Viewfinder/Format) in the bottom bar row 1 and choose **Focal Length**. Select a built-in focal length, a custom numeric focal length, or a compatible lens from the **Personal Lens Catalog**. The viewfinder magnification adjusts so the framing matches what that lens sees on film.



(Example) Lens & Format picker over the web preview. The live viewfinder image is available in the installed app.

A catalog lens appears only when its format threshold or image-circle coverage supports the selected film format. Selecting it applies its focal length and limits aperture choices to its marked and inferred f-stops. Shutter recommendations are limited to one source at a time: mechanical lens marks, a custom shutter preset, or a rolling-shutter profile. Choosing a competing source asks you to switch rather than combining speed lists. When the ideal falls outside the selected source's range, it remains visible in red for reference and the saved Journal setting uses the nearest supported speed. For an ideal exposure longer than the slowest mark, the meter displays the ideal duration so you can select Bulb on the camera. A no-shutter lens keeps the general shutter choices.

CAMERA LENS

On iOS and supported Android devices, choose among the available rear-camera lenses (such as ultra-wide, main/wide, or telephoto) in **Settings → Viewfinder → Camera Lens**. Available lenses depend on the phone. Auto-selection switches only among available lenses that have been calibrated.

GRID OVERLAYS

Tap the **Grid button** in bottom bar row 1 to cycle through:

- **None** — clean viewfinder
- **Rule of Thirds** — 3×3 grid
- **Golden Ratio** — Phi-based grid
- **Crosshair** — centre cross

TAP TO FOCUS

On cameras that support focus-point control, tap the viewfinder to request focus at that point. A focus ring confirms the tap; the camera may not change focus if it does not support this control.

LOCK FREEZE

On iOS and Android, tapping **LOCK** captures and displays a still image in place of the live preview, so you can study the framing or composition while the exposure reading stays fixed. The live preview resumes when you tap **UNLOCK**. On web, locking freezes the reading but does not capture a still image.

VIEWFINDER MARGIN

Adjust the inner margin of the frame lines via **Settings → Viewfinder → Viewfinder Margin** (0–20%). Useful to simulate camera-specific viewfinder coverage.

FILM FRAME ORIENTATION

Set the simulated film frame to **Portrait** or **Landscape** in **Settings → Viewfinder → Orientation**. This changes the frame, not the phone screen.

SCREEN ROTATION AND HANDEDNESS

Screen rotation is off by default. To use the horizontal meter, enable **Allow Screen Rotation** in **Settings → Viewfinder**, then rotate your phone. Choose **Left** or **Right** under **Landscape Controls** to place the control panel on your preferred side. Your customized toolbar button order and rows are retained. Turn off Allow Screen Rotation to keep the meter screen in portrait. This is separate from Film Frame Orientation.

7. Viewfinder Zoom Slider

The vertical amber slider on the **left edge of the viewfinder** lets you change your film lens focal length on the fly to scout compositions without touching the focal length dial.

HOW TO USE

- **Drag up** — increases focal length (zooms in, narrower field of view)
- **Drag down** — decreases focal length (zooms out, wider field of view)
- Both the viewfinder framing and the metering update live while dragging
- The focal length label next to the handle shows the current value as you drag

SCALE & RANGE

- The scale is **logarithmic** spanning **25mm to 1500mm** — every 80 pixels of drag shifts focal length by one stop (×2 or ÷2)
- The small pip at the centre of the track marks approximately **194mm** on the absolute scale

ENABLING / DISABLING

- **Quick toggle:** Settings → Viewfinder → **Zoom Slider** — turns the slider on or off for the current session
- **Hide entirely:** Settings → App Tools Configuration → **Viewfinder Zoom Slider** — removes both the slider and its Settings row

8. Auto Lens Selection

With this enabled, ProFilm Meter selects an available, calibrated phone camera lens as the viewfinder focal length changes.

Enable: Settings → Viewfinder → **Auto-select camera lens**

HOW THE SELECTION WORKS

The app checks each lens's field of view and zoom limit, favoring a lens that needs less digital zoom. If no lens fits, it may use the widest lens that can cover the framing. Lens availability varies by device, and each candidate needs its own calibration profile.

FLASH MODE

When flash is armed, the app saves the current lens and switches to an available main/rear lens only if that lens has a calibration profile. If it is unavailable or uncalibrated, the current lens stays selected and a calibration nudge may appear. Disarming flash restores the previous lens. Focal-length auto-selection pauses while flash is active.

CALIBRATION REQUIREMENT

Auto lens selection uses calibrated lenses. If the preferred lens is uncalibrated, a nudge banner may prompt you to calibrate it. Tap **Calibrate** on the banner to open the guide for that lens.

9. Histogram

The RGB histogram overlay in the viewfinder shows the distribution of red, green, and blue channel values across the current frame.

- **Clustered left** — underexposure
- **Clustered right** — overexposure
- **Spread across** — full tonal range

The histogram updates continuously from the live camera preview and is automatically hidden during flash mode to prioritise capture speed.

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10. Scene Color Temperature

When enabled, a live Kelvin (K) badge appears on the viewfinder showing the estimated scene color temperature derived from the RGB balance of the live camera frame.

RANGE	LIGHT SOURCE
2700–3200 K	Incandescent / tungsten
5500–6500 K	Daylight
7000 K+	Open shade / overcast

When RA4 Color Reversal is enabled, this value also drives the CMY filter pack recommendations.

Enable: Settings → Preferences → **Show Color Temperature**

11. Flash Metering

ARMING

Tap the **Flash button** in bottom bar row 1 to arm flash detection. The button label changes to **Hold to Disarm** when armed.

HOW IT WORKS

Once armed, the current ambient EV is captured and locked as a reference. Fire your flash unit; the meter detects the peak brightness spike and calculates the correct exposure for that burst. A **FLASH** chip appears in the viewfinder and the EV display holds the flash reading. The ambient EV is shown below for comparison.

If **RA4 Color Reversal** is enabled, a separate color temperature analysis runs on the flash peak frame and appears with an amber-bordered badge.

RE-ARMING

Tap **Hold to Disarm** (or the flash icon again) to re-arm for the next shot, resetting the peak hold.

FLASH MODULE

The flash detection engine has been fully rebuilt to handle the updated camera data paths on both iOS and Android. It is still being refined — choose the least sensitive flash sensitivity setting that works for your setup and do a couple of test exposures to verify you are capturing the flash correctly before committing to a session.

FLASH TRIGGER

If a Flash Trigger mode is configured (see Section 12), a **Trigger** button appears in the viewfinder. Tap it to fire the flash signal — the meter then automatically records the peak.

FLASH SENSITIVITY

Access: Settings → Metering → **Flash Sensitivity**

Flash Sensitivity controls how large a brightness spike the meter must see before classifying a frame as a flash event. A lower threshold catches weaker flashes; a higher threshold avoids false triggers from bright ambient light.

> **Important:** *After changing sensitivity,* **re-arm the flash** *(disarm then re-arm) for the new setting to take effect.*

> **Note:** *The flash module has been significantly rebuilt. Choose the least sensitive setting that reliably detects your flash, and do a couple of test exposures to verify you are capturing the burst correctly before committing to a session.*

LEVEL	SPIKE RATIO	WHEN TO USE
Maximum	1.05	Catches a 5% brightness increase — even a faint flash bounce through diffusion. Use for heavily diffused strobes, very weak fill flash bounced off a far ceiling, or low-power pops. Risk: may false-trigger on bright window glare, reflections, or moving headlights.
High	1.08	For subtle fill flash, ratio lighting (main + low-power fill), or when bouncing through thin diffusion panels.
Normal *(default)*	1.10	Balanced for most controlled studio and location flash work. A 10% spike is well above typical ambient variation in a studio or shaded outdoor location.
Reduced	1.15	Use outdoors in bright conditions (daylight fill flash), near bright windows, or when you are getting occasional false triggers at Normal.
Low	1.25	Use in highly variable ambient light — strong sunlight with cloud gaps, shooting near moving water or reflective surfaces. Only a clear, direct flash hit registers.
Minimum	1.50	Use only when you keep getting false triggers at all other settings — bright sun reflecting off glass, moving vehicle headlights, or high-contrast flicker lighting. Requires a strong direct flash hit to register.

Practical tips:

- Start at **Normal** and drop to **High** or **Maximum** only if the flash isn't registering
- Move up to **Reduced** or **Low** if you get false triggers from ambient light changes
- In a controlled studio with no ambient light variation, **Normal** or **High** always works

- Outdoors in full sun, start at **Reduced**; if still false-triggering, try **Low**

FLASH DURATION AND FLASH EV TRIM

Flash Duration is the assumed strobe burst length (t0.1) used for EV deconvolution. Choose 0.5, 1, 2, 4, 8, or 15 ms; the default is **4 ms**. Longer durations lower the estimated flash peak and EV, while shorter durations raise them.

Flash EV Trim appears in Settings → Metering while flash mode is active. It applies a flash-only offset from **−2 to +2 EV** in one-third-stop steps; ambient readings are unchanged. Compare readings with an incident meter at the same distance and ISO, then adjust the trim to match.

CAMERA ND FILTER (FLASH METERING)

Access: Settings → Metering → **Camera ND Filter**

Phone camera sensors are small and can overload — clip to solid white — when a very powerful flash fires at close range. Studio packs like **Speedotron** or **Norman** running at 4,000 Ws can saturate the sensor before the app can measure anything useful, causing the reading to be clipped and inaccurate.

When the viewfinder shows the warning ⚠ **Flash may be too bright to meter accurately**, place a physical ND filter over the phone's rear camera lens to bring the light level within range, then tell the app which density you used so it can add those stops back.

How to use

1. Place a physical ND filter over the phone's rear camera lens — a gel taped over the camera window works fine.
2. In Settings → Metering, tap **Camera ND Filter** and select the density you used:
   ND 0.3 (1 stop) • ND 0.6 (2 stops) • ND 0.9 (3 stops) • ND 1.8 (6 stops) • ND 3.0 (10 stops)
3. The app adds the selected stop value to every flash EV reading automatically. The active density appears as a chip on the meter screen as a reminder.
4. When you no longer need the filter, tap **None** in the same picker and remove the physical filter from the lens.

> **Tip:** *For Speedotron or Norman packs at 4,000 Ws at close range, ND 3.0 (10 stops) is a good starting point. Test at a mid-power setting first to confirm the filter is dense enough before working at full power.*

12. Flash Trigger Modes

Access: Settings → Metering → **Flash Trigger**

When a trigger mode other than **Off** or **Light Sensor** is selected and flash is armed, a **Trigger** button appears in the centre of the viewfinder. Tap it to send the fire signal — the meter then automatically records the peak.

OFF

No trigger signal is sent. Fire your flash manually at any time while the meter is armed. The meter will detect the peak spike whenever it occurs.

When to use: Any situation where you control the flash shutter sync yourself — a standard sync cable plugged into the camera, a flash connected to the camera hot shoe, or a radio trigger fired by the camera. The app just meters the flash, it doesn't need to fire it.

Hardware needed: None.

OPTICAL SLAVE (LED)

The phone's rear LED torch fires a short burst of light to trip the optical slave sensor built into most studio strobes and many speedlights. No cable needed.

When to use: When your strobe has an optical slave (S1 or S2) mode and you can't or don't want to run a sync cable. It works well for portable location setups, older studio strobes without radio triggers, and quick wireless tests.

Hardware needed: A flash unit with an optical slave (S1/S2) mode. Nothing else required.

Torch Duration: The length of the LED burst. Configurable in Settings → Metering → **Torch Duration**:

DURATION	USE
50 ms	Fast slaves, short-duration strobes
100 ms	Most standard optical slaves
150 ms *(default)*	Reliable for most units, including older slaves
200 ms	Sluggish or heavily diffused slaves, or those needing a longer trigger pulse

Tips for best results:

- Point the phone toward the flash unit's optical sensor window — within 45° of axis
- Keep the phone within ~3–5 metres of the sensor for reliable triggering in bright ambient light
- In very bright sunlight, optical slaves may not respond — consider Cable Sync or radio triggers instead
- S2 mode on most strobes ignores the pre-flash from digital cameras; S1 mode fires on any light pulse

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CABLE SYNC (3.5MM)

The app plays an experimental audio transient through the headphone jack; it is not a true electrical sync pulse. With Cable Sync active, Settings → Metering offers **Sine**, **Square** (default), or **Sawtooth** waveforms and pulse lengths of **20–500 ms** (**100 ms** default). Compatibility varies by phone, adapter, and flash.

When to use: With a compatible, properly isolated interface between the phone's audio output and a flash unit's PC sync input.

Hardware needed:

- USB-C → 3.5mm audio adapter, if the phone does not have a headphone jack
- A properly rated optoisolator between the phone and the flash sync cable
- A flash unit with a PC sync (male coaxial sync) input

High-voltage safety warning: Many studio flash units carry 200–400 V on their PC sync rail. Never connect the phone directly to a flash sync port, including through a USB-C audio adapter. A plain 3.5mm-to-PC-sync cable is not safe; use a properly rated optoisolator. Cable Sync is experimental.

LIGHT SENSOR *(ANDROID ONLY)*

Uses the device's hardware ambient light sensor to detect the flash spike automatically. The sensor responds in milliseconds — faster than the camera — and confirms the flash event for more reliable capture.

When to use: On Android, this is a simple option when the flash is close enough to brighten the room around the phone. Arm the meter, fire the flash, and let the sensor detect it.

Hardware needed: None. Not available on iOS (iPhones do not expose the ambient light sensor to apps).

Tips: Position the phone with the ambient light sensor (usually near the earpiece or on the front face) visible to the flash or at least in the same room. Works best with bare strobes or large softboxes; less reliable through heavy diffusion or bounce off distant surfaces.

13. Film Stocks & Reciprocity Failure

SELECTING A FILM STOCK

Open the film stock picker from the **ISO/Film button** on the Control Bar — tap it, then switch to the **Film Stock tab**. You can also reach it via Settings → Gear Management → Film Stocks. Tap any stock to select it.

Your **Preferred Setups** appear at the top of the Film Stock tab for one-tap recall. The full stock list follows beneath them.

Selecting a stock applies its native ISO and links its reciprocity profile automatically. If you manually change the ISO dial after selecting a stock, the stock is deselected and your previous settings are restored.

ZEBRA DRY PLATES COLLECTION

The app includes the full Zebra Dry Plates catalogue (ISO 2, blue-sensitive). These include dry plates, tintypes, and golden tintypes. Zebra stocks show a **cart icon** linking directly to the Zebra store to purchase.

Tap **Zebra Dry Plates Film Stocks** in the stock picker to browse and add stocks from the live catalogue (fetched from GitHub and cached locally for up to one hour). If the cache is missing or expired, an internet connection is needed to load the catalogue.

Selecting a tintype or other stock marked for Positive Exposure automatically selects **Dryplate Positive** (+0.5 stop by default).

RECIPROCITY FAILURE

Film loses sensitivity at long exposure times — a phenomenon called reciprocity failure. Each emulsion has a Schwarzschild exponent (p-factor) describing how severe this is.

Workflow:

1. Select a reciprocity profile in **Settings → Gear Management → Film Stocks → Reciprocity Profile**
2. During live metering the shutter always shows the raw calculated time. When it crosses the profile's threshold, a teal **RECIP** chip appears
3. Tap **LOCK** — the corrected duration (calculated from the locked time using the film's p-factor) appears in teal above the raw shutter value
4. Set your camera to the corrected time

5. If the displayed locked duration exceeds 1 second, a **Timer** chip appears at the bottom of the viewfinder — tap it to open the Countdown Timer pre-loaded with that duration

Custom threshold: Tap the threshold value next to any profile to override it for your personal test results. Tap the refresh icon to restore the factory default.

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14. Preferred Setups

Save named combinations of settings so you can bring them back with one tap.

WHAT A SETUP STORES

- Name (e.g. "4×5 Ortho Sunny Day")
- Film stock + reciprocity profile
- Aperture
- Built-in focal length or Personal Lens Catalog lens
- Rolling Shutter Camera profile (optional)
- Custom Shutter Preset (optional)
- Optional overrides for:
  - Environmental Compensation
  - RA4 Color Reversal
  - Positive Exposure process and compensation
  - IR Compensation (when set to On, a wavelength sub-option appears: 720 nm / 850 nm / Don't set)

Lens UV compensation (optional): Save its On/Off state and choose either UV data from the linked Personal Lens Catalog entry or a manual glass/coating type, including a custom UV transmission percentage. Missing catalog UV data is identified in the editor. This is separate from the RA4 UV-filter setting.

RA4 and filter overrides (optional): RA4 paper, the standard Base Filter (85B or Double CTO), whether it is physically on the lens, a specific Physical catalog filter, the available-filter library, RA4 UV-filter state, and light source. The standard Base Filter is the default warming reference; selecting a Physical catalog filter uses that specific filter's shift instead when Base Filter on Lens is enabled. When RA4 is enabled in a setup, **Keep** leaves an optional value unchanged; **None** or **Base filter** explicitly clears or selects the corresponding option where shown.

CREATING A SETUP

Go to **Settings → Preferred Setups** and tap +. Name the setup, choose which values to store, set any toggle overrides, and tap Save.

APPLYING A SETUP

Saved setups appear at the **top of the film stock picker** (above the full stock list). Applying one clears general meter filters from the previous setup; its IR filter is selected only when IR is on in that setup. If RA4 is off or not explicitly enabled, RA4 is turned off, its selected paper and physical catalog filter are cleared, and the base-filter-on-lens state is reset.

EDITING & DELETING

In **Settings** → **Preferred Setups**, tap a setup to edit it or swipe left to delete it.

15. Positive Exposure

Choose **Off**, **Dryplate Positive**, or **Paper Reversal** in **Settings → Compensations → Positive Exposure**.

- Dryplate Positive is for positive dry plates; Paper Reversal is for black-and-white paper reversal
- Dryplate Positive starts at **+0.5 stop**; Paper Reversal starts at **+2.5 stops**
- Adjust compensation in **0.1-stop** steps
- Selecting a stock marked for Positive Exposure automatically selects Dryplate Positive
- The chosen process and compensation are applied to metering and shown with saved exposure information
- Preferred Setups can independently save and restore the process and compensation
- Applies in addition to any other compensation

16. Bellows Compensation

Bellows compensation corrects for the light loss when extending the lens beyond its infinity focus position — essential for large format and macro photography.

Access: Open the bellows panel from the **Bellows button** in bottom bar row 2. Enter only the extra extension beyond infinity focus (generally the length of the lens). This is not the total bellows draw. Make sure that you have the correct lens selected in the viewfinder. When a non-zero value is set, a **+Xmm** chip appears in the status row confirming the compensation is active. Tap the Bellows button again to disable it and clear the value.

The compensation formula is:

> **Extra stops = 2 × log₂(total draw ÷ focal length)**

Here, **total draw = focal length + extra extension**. For example, a 150 mm lens with 30 mm of extra extension needs about **+0.52 stops**; 75 mm of extra extension needs about **+1.17 stops**.

To clear: Tap the Bellows button again to disable compensation, or set the extension field back to 0.

17. Lens Filters

Access: Tap the **Filters button** in bottom bar row 2.

Select a filter to automatically apply its exposure compensation factor. Available filters include:

CATEGORY	FILTERS
Contrast	Yellow K2, Orange G, Red 25A, Green X1
Neutral density	ND2 through ND1000
Polarizer	Circular polarizer
Infrared	720 nm, 850 nm

The filter factor is automatically added to your exposure calculation.

IR Filters: The 720 nm and 850 nm slots are linked to the IR Light Estimator. Changing the wavelength in either place syncs the other automatically.

18. Spectral Sensitivity

Access: Settings → Compensations → **Spectral Sensitivity**

Adjusts the meter's readings to match the spectral response of your film.

MODE	FILM TYPE
Panchromatic	All modern films — responds to all visible light
Orthochromatic	Ilford Ortho Plus and similar — ignores red light
Blue-Sensitive	Early emulsions, cyanotype, Zebra dry plates — responds mainly to blue/UV

TWO CORRECTION PATHS

1. **Real-time RGB analysis (primary):** When the camera is delivering live frames, the meter analyses the actual colour of the light and computes a spectral correction. This is the most accurate path and is shown as a **Spectral** badge on the viewfinder.
2. **Solar-elevation color temperature:** Derived from GPS location and the sun's current elevation. It is the fallback when live RGB analysis is unavailable. For orthochromatic and blue-sensitive modes, a half-strength residual color-temperature component can also accompany live RGB analysis to account for camera white balance.

PINPOINT SPECTRAL SCAN

In spot metering mode, a **Scan Scene** button appears next to the Spectral badge. Tapping it captures the light colour at the exact spot selected and locks that correction in place (shown as a 🔒 badge). Useful when the main subject has different light than the wider scene. The lock persists until you tap ✕ next to the badge, switch film stocks, or change spectral mode.

19. Environmental Compensation

Access: Settings → Compensations → **Environmental Compensation**

Automatically adjusts for altitude and UV conditions using your GPS location to determine elevation and UV index.

- Most useful for high-altitude landscape photography
- Last known coordinates are cached locally and reused across restarts as a fallback
- **Manual UV override:** Tap the UV field and enter a value (0–11+) to override GPS-based UV data. Tap Clear to return to automatic readings.

COLOR TEMPERATURE COMPONENT

For blue-sensitive and orthochromatic film, the meter also accounts for solar elevation:

- Warm light (golden hour, low sun) contains less blue/UV energy — film needs more exposure
- The correction is negative (reduces metered EV, calling for longer shutter or wider aperture)
- At midday with high solar elevation the correction approaches zero
- Automatically suppressed when live RGB spectral analysis is active (the two corrections are not stacked)

UV LENS COATING

Access: Enable the optional control in **Settings → Preferences → App Tools Configuration → UV Lens Coating**, then open **Settings → Compensations → Lens UV Coating**.

Modern lens coatings reduce the UV-A that reaches film. Choose the coating on your camera lens so the app can scale its UV compensation to match the light that passes through it.

Select **UV-Transparent**, **Uncoated**, **Single Coating**, **Multi-Coating (MC)**, **Super MC / Nano**, or **UV-Cut**. Choose **Custom %** when you know the lens's UV-A transmission and enter that value directly.

20. RA4 Color Reversal

Access: Settings → RA4 Color Reversal toggle, or the **RA4** button on the Meter screen.

When enabled, the meter analyses scene color and suggests CC filter corrections for in-camera RA4 color printing. RA4 papers are balanced for 3200 K tungsten; the filter pack compensates for the actual scene light. During flash mode a separate RA4 analysis runs on the flash peak frame and appears with an amber-bordered badge.

PAPER STOCK

RA4 paper choices come from the papers installed under **Settings → Gear Management → Film Stocks**. Only papers with valid RA4 color-balance and saturation calibration appear; ordinary film profiles without RA4 data cannot be selected. The picker shows each paper's ISO, nominal balance, tint correction in mireds, and saturation factor. Add calibrated RA4 papers to Film Stocks. Removing a paper from Gear Management removes it from the RA4 picker and clears its selection, so recommendations cannot use a paper that is no longer installed.

COLOR TEMPERATURE — Y / B FILTERS

The meter measures the mired gap between the scene and the paper balance. Cool scenes (daylight, overcast, electronic flash) sit well above 3200 K and need **Yellow** filters to warm the light reaching the paper — typical daylight recommendations range from CC20Y to CC50Y or more. Scenes warmer than 3200 K (deep tungsten, candlelight) need **Blue** filters. This shift is large enough that phone Auto White Balance (AWB) cannot fully mask it, so Y/B suggestions work correctly without any preset.

LIGHT SOURCE — M / G FILTERS

Green and magenta casts from fluorescent, LED, and similar sources are subtle — phone AWB removes them before the app can measure them. The **Light Source** preset adds the known correction back in:

PRESET	FILTER ADDED	NOTES
Daylight / Flash	None	AWB handles these reliably; no preset needed
Tungsten 3200K	CC05M	Very clean spectrum; minimal cast
Fluorescent — Cool White	CC30M	Strong green spike
Fluorescent — Warm White	CC20M	Moderate green spike
LED — Cool White	CC20M	Variable; CC20M is a reliable starting point
LED — Warm White	CC10M	Near-neutral; light trim
HMI / Metal-Halide	CC10M	Slight green push from arc discharge

These are typical values for most paper stocks. Kodak Endura Metallic's saturation tuning may yield one density step higher (e.g. CC40M for cool fluorescent). Make a test strip under the actual lamp and fine-tune — batch variation between tubes and ballasts can shift the correction by ±5–10 density units.

BASE FILTER ON LENS

Under **Settings → Gear Management → Filter Catalog**, enable the warming filters you actually have. Only enabled warming filters, including 85B and Double CTO, can be selected as an RA4 base filter or used in recommendations; cooling filters are not valid warming base filters. Disabling or removing a selected filter clears it from the RA4 base-filter selection and excludes it from later recommendations, including flash recommendations. If no warming filter is enabled, enable one in Gear Management. **Base Filter** selects the standard 85B or Double CTO warming reference. **Physical catalog filter** instead identifies a specific catalog item; when **Base Filter on Lens** is enabled, that item supplies the physical filter shift used for the on-lens calculation. The on-lens toggle means you will physically use the selected filter while shooting; otherwise the recommendation remains a CC-only correction or reports that the required correction is out of range.

UV FILTER

RA4 silver-chloride paper is highly UV-sensitive, but the phone camera has a built-in UV/IR cut — the color analysis never sees the UV your paper will receive. Without a UV filter on the shooting

lens, the paper's blue-sensitive layer is exposed to UV the meter never measured, skewing results toward blue. A **UV filter is standard practice for all RA4 reversal filter packs**, and the toggle defaults to on.

When enabled, the filter pack shows a **UV+** prefix (e.g. **UV+CC20Y**, **UV+85B+Balanced**) and the meter adds ⅓ stop of exposure to cover the filter's visible violet-blue absorption. When disabled while RA4 is active, an amber *"No UV filter — result may skew blue"* warning appears in the viewfinder badge.

FILTER PACK FORMAT

- **Y** — Yellow; scene cooler than paper balance (typical daylight)
- **B** — Blue; scene warmer than paper balance (below ~3500 K)
- **M** — Magenta; green cast in the scene light
- **G** — Green; magenta cast in the scene light
- **Balanced** — no correction needed
- **85B+…** — use an 85B filter first, then add the CC trim shown

METERING MODE

Use **center-weighted or average metering**. Spot metering samples too small an area for reliable color temperature estimation and gives inconsistent filter pack suggestions.

21. IR Light Estimator

Access: Settings → **IR Light Estimator** section

Estimates the current strength of infrared light. Use it when planning IR photography with 720 nm or 850 nm filters.

The estimator combines GPS-based solar elevation, UV index, and live spectral camera data to produce an **IR strength index (0–10)** shown as a label (Low, Moderate, High, Very High) and a bar graph.

FILTER SELECTION

Tap **720 nm** or **850 nm** to choose your IR filter. This is synced with the Lens Filter sheet on the Meter screen — changing the wavelength in either place syncs the other. Enabling IR Estimation automatically adds the currently selected filter to the meter; disabling it removes it.

EV ADJUSTMENT

The **"+ N stops"** chip shows the estimated additional exposure needed for the selected filter under current conditions. Use this as a starting point.

INDICATORS

- **Solar Elevation** — sun's angle above the horizon; a lower angle means more atmospheric IR scattering
- **UV Index** — higher UV generally means stronger IR output

OFFLINE MODE

Core metering and exposure calculations work offline. UV index and solar elevation are estimated from latitude, season, and time of day when no internet connection is available.

When live environmental data is requested, the available latitude and longitude are sent to Open-Meteo. Remote stock and filter catalogues are fetched from GitHub and cached locally for up to one hour; if a cache is missing or expired, an internet connection is needed to load the catalogue.

22. Two-Point Calibration

Calibrate the app against a trusted light meter for maximum accuracy. Each camera and lens combination (front, rear main, ultra-wide, telephoto) gets its own independent calibration profile.

Access: Settings → Metering → **Calibrate Light Meter**

THE PROCESS

The guided calibration measures both a dark and a bright reference scene using one of five supported light sources:

- Incandescent bulb
- LED panel
- Phone screen
- Overcast sky
- Window light

At the end, the app saves gain and offset corrections for that camera and lens combination.

CALIBRATION PROMPT

If calibration is missing, the meter may show a prompt to calibrate the active camera configuration. The prompt can be skipped where the current workflow allows it.

FINE-TUNE VS REFERENCE METER

After base calibration, an optional step appears: point both your phone and a trusted reference meter (e.g. Sekonic) at the same scene, enter the reference EV reading, and the app saves an **EV offset** to close any remaining gap. Return to this step at any time via **Settings → Metering → Fine-tune with Reference Meter**.

SW BADGE

A small amber **SW** label appears next to the Measured EV whenever the app is estimating from software rather than raw camera EXIF (e.g. briefly during camera startup or lens switching). Accuracy is slightly lower during this period — wait a moment for it to disappear before taking a critical reading.

23. Field Journal

Access: The **Journal** tab at the top of the screen.

SAVING AN EXPOSURE

Tap **SAVE** on the Meter screen. A confirmation screen appears where you can:

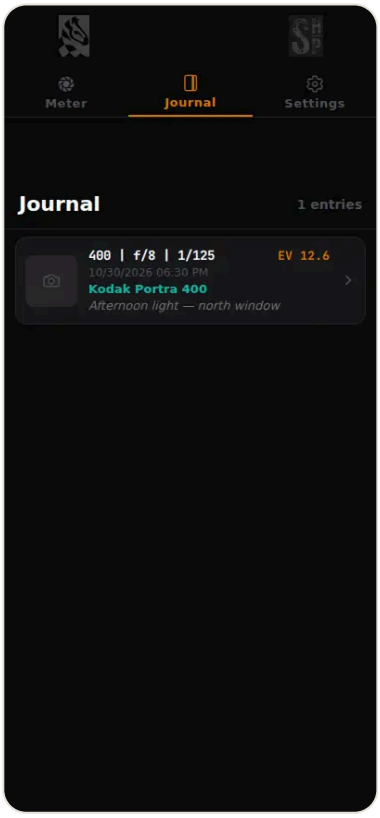
- Review all captured exposure data
- Add notes
- Attach the viewfinder photo

Tap **Save Entry** to confirm.

JOURNAL LIST

Each entry shows compact modifier chips below the exposure values — coloured icons for active lens filters, manual exposure compensation, bellows extension, and environmental compensation — so you can see at a glance what was applied without opening the full detail view.

When a multi-point exposure is saved, a numbered chip appears in this row. Tap it to expand an inline panel directly on the list card showing the individual EV recorded at each point (P1, P2, P3 ...).



(Example) Journal with a sample exposure.

VIEWING AN ENTRY

Tap any entry to open the full detail view, which shows:

- All exposure settings (ISO, aperture, shutter, EV)
- Film stock and format
- All active compensations
- Location, when recorded
- RA4 filter pack data
- Selected Personal Lens Catalog lens and its captured shutter/UV compensation details
- Attached photo with metering indicator overlay

Lens details in a journal entry are a snapshot. Editing or removing a catalog lens does not rewrite saved entries.

The photo overlay shows an amber indicator marking the metering mode and spot/center-weighted area that was active at save time.

EXPORTING

From the detail view:

- **Save to Gallery** — saves the composite card (photo + data overlay) as a JPEG. On iOS and Android, the app attempts to embed exposure details and any recorded coordinates in EXIF; if embedding fails, the image can still be saved or shared without that metadata. Web exports do not add EXIF metadata.
- **Share** — opens the system share sheet with the composite card

SAVE ALL TO GALLERY

A download icon appears in the top-right corner of the journal list header whenever at least one entry has a photo attached (iOS and Android only). Tap it to bulk-save the attached photos. Android saves to Camera Roll; iOS also attempts to use the app album. A confirmation alert shows the photo count before saving begins.

AUTO-SAVE TO GALLERY

Found in **Settings > Preferences > Auto-save to Gallery**. When enabled, each new journal photo is saved automatically after the entry is created. Android saves to Camera Roll; iOS also attempts to use the app album. Web does not save photos to a device library. If photo-library access is denied, a permission alert may appear again after 30 seconds.

DELETING AN ENTRY

Swipe left on any journal entry and tap **Delete**.

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24. Countdown Timer

Access: When exposure is locked and the displayed duration exceeds 1 second, a **Timer** chip appears at the bottom of the viewfinder. This uses the reciprocity-corrected duration when correction is active. Tap the chip to open the Countdown Timer.

Counts down from the currently displayed shutter speed. It is useful for long exposures where you time the shutter by hand.

Workflow:

1. Lock your exposure
2. Tap the **Timer** chip
3. A 3-second preparation countdown runs first — open your shutter during this window
4. The main countdown begins with a visual arc ring
5. On supported native devices, haptics mark the countdown and completion. The app does not play a completion beep; web does not provide haptic alerts.
6. Tap **Cancel** at any time to stop

Reciprocity toggle: When reciprocity failure correction is active, the timer shows a toggle between the corrected duration and the original base time. The corrected (reciprocity) time is selected by default — this is the duration your shutter should stay open.

25. Extra Tools

Access all Extra Tools via **Settings → Extra Tools tab** (wrench icon).

25.1 DEPTH OF FIELD CALCULATOR

Enter your film format, focal length, aperture, and subject distance to calculate:

- Near limit of sharp focus
- Far limit of sharp focus
- Total depth of field
- Hyperfocal distance

The circle of confusion (CoC) is automatically derived from the selected film format. Distance can be entered in metric (mm/m) or imperial (inches/feet). Results update instantly.

Hyperfocal tip: When focused at the hyperfocal distance, everything from half that distance to infinity is acceptably sharp.

25.2 ALTERNATIVE PROCESSES METER

Supported processes with calibrated nominal ISOs:

- **Classic Cyanotype** (ISO ~0.01) — Prussian-blue prints from ferric salts; the original blueprint process.
- **New Cyanotype** (ISO ~0.05) — faster, higher-contrast variant using ferric ammonium oxalate.
- **Salt Print** (ISO ~0.01) — earliest photographic paper; silver chloride gives warm sepia tones.
- **Platinum/Palladium** (ISO ~0.003) — archival; rich neutral-to-warm tones with wide tonal range.
- **Van Dyke Brown** (ISO ~0.008) — iron-silver contact process; warm brown tones.
- **Kallitype** (ISO ~0.008) — iron-silver process; toneable to sepia, neutral black, or blue-black.
- **Gum Bichromate** (ISO ~0.02) — pigment and gum arabic; painterly results, multi-layer capable.

Setup:

1. Select your process
2. Select your light source: **Sunlight** (uses live UV index from GPS) or indoor (UV lamp, LED, fluorescent)
3. The meter calculates an estimated print time based on current UV conditions
4. Use the **±3 stop fine-tune control** to dial in your personal process

The live UV indicator shows the current index and whether readings are live (GPS) or estimated. Falls back to an offline estimate from latitude and time of day when UV data is unavailable.

Glass UV Compensation

Two toggles below the fine-tune slider account for UV-absorbing glass layers in the printing stack. Standard soda-lime float glass (3–4 mm) transmits approximately 70% of UV at 365 nm — each glass layer in the optical path costs roughly **+½ stop** of additional print time.

TOGGLE	OPTIONS	WHEN TO USE "GLASS"
Negative Substrate	Plastic / Film · Glass Plate	Your negative is on a glass plate (ambrotype, wet-plate interpositive, glass lantern slide). Leave on *Plastic / Film* for conventional film base.
Contact Frame Top Plate	None · Glass	Your contact printing frame has a glass pressure plate over the negative. Set to *None* if you print with the frame open or under a UV-transparent acrylic lid.

The meter multiplies the computed print time by `1 / 0.70` per enabled layer (≈ +0.51 stops each). Both layers together cost approximately **+1 stop**. The correction is applied automatically.

25.3 NEGATIVE DENSITY READER

Found inside the Alternative Processes Meter. Measures the transmission density of a developed negative held over the device screen.

Two-step workflow:

1. **No negative** — tap **Sample Baseline** with nothing over the screen. Captures bare screen brightness as a reference.
2. **Place negative** — lay the negative emulsion-down over the lit crop guide, then tap **Sample Negative**. Calculates density as D = $\log_{10}$(baseline ÷ transmitted light).

D value guide:

D VALUE	INTERPRETATION
< 0.5	Thin — underexposed or underdeveloped
0.5–1.0	Normal — standard print exposure
1.0–1.5	Dense — overexposed or overdeveloped
> 1.5	Very dense — significantly extended print times needed

The **stops correction** value shows how many stops of additional (or reduced) exposure your print needs relative to normal density.

Re-sample the baseline whenever you change screen brightness or move environments.

25.4 WET PLATE TIMER

Estimates how long you have after pulling a collodion-coated plate from the sensitizing tank before the emulsion dries, then counts that window down.

Estimation factors:

- **Temperature** — warmer air evaporates solvent faster (rate doubles roughly every 11 °C above 20 °C)
- **Humidity** — drier air shortens the window sharply (90% RH gives ~3× longer window than 50% RH)
- **Elevation** — lower air pressure at altitude speeds evaporation slightly
- **Wind Exposure** — None / Light / Strong (Strong can cut the window to ~⅓ of calm-air value)

When **Environmental Compensation** is enabled and GPS data is available, temperature, humidity, and elevation are read automatically (shown with a teal **Live** badge). Otherwise, manual sliders appear.

Timer:

- **Amber** — under 30 seconds remaining
- **Red + pulsing** — under 10 seconds remaining
- Tap **Stop** to pause, **Reset** to recalculate (useful if conditions change)

25.5 STEP WEDGE TOOL

Generates a bracketed series of timed exposures around a base value for film test strips, contact-print calibration, and alternative-process tests.

Mode: Choose **Camera** (shutter-speed exposures) or **Alt Process** (print times from the Alternative Processes tool).

Setup:

- **Steps:** 3, 5, 7, or 9 (always odd — center step is the base)
- **Stop increment per step:** ⅓, ½, ⅔, or 1 stop
- **Base time:** In Camera mode, enter as a decimal in seconds (e.g. 0.0125 for 1/80 s, 2 for 2 s). In Alt Process mode, enter in MM:SS.

Import shortcut: In Camera mode, lock the meter on the Meter tab and tap **Import** — the locked shutter value fills automatically. In Alt Process mode, compute a print time first and tap **Import** to fill the base time.

Running the sequence:

- Tap **Run Sequence** → **Start Sequence** to begin the first exposure immediately
- Each step counts down with an arc ring and vibrates + beeps when complete
- Tap **Start Next Step** when ready — the sequence never advances automatically
- Tap **Skip Step** to mark the current step done early, or **Cancel** to stop

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25.6 RECIPROCITY CALCULATOR

Applies the reciprocity failure correction formula to a measured exposure time to output the corrected time you should actually use.

Mode:

- **Film Profile** — select from your saved reciprocity profiles (same profiles used by the live meter)
- **Manual** — enter a custom p-factor and threshold directly

Calculation: Enter the measured exposure time in seconds. If the time is at or below the threshold, a note confirms no correction is needed. If it exceeds the threshold, the result shows measured time, corrected time, and extra time added. Results update instantly.

25.7 EQUIVALENT LENS CALCULATOR

Converts focal lengths between any film format and the 35mm full-frame reference, and displays the angle of view for both.

Mode:

- **Format → 35mm** — enter an actual focal length on your chosen format and see its 35mm equivalent
- **35mm → Format** — enter a 35mm focal length and find the actual focal length needed on your chosen format

Results: Shows focal length, diagonal angle of view, and horizontal × vertical angles for both sides. Results update instantly.

25.8 PINHOLE CALCULATOR

Characterises a pinhole camera by calculating effective f-stop, optimal pinhole diameter (Rayleigh criterion), and image circle coverage.

F/Stop Mode: Enter pinhole diameter (mm) and focal distance (mm/cm/inches). Results show:

- Effective f-stop
- Optimal pinhole diameter for maximum sharpness at that focal distance
- Image circle diameter at 90° AoV
- Which standard film formats fit within it

Coverage Mode: Enter pinhole diameter and select a film format. Shows three recommended focal distances:

- **Standard** (53° diagonal AoV)
- **Wide** (80° diagonal AoV)
- **Extra Wide** (110° diagonal AoV)

Each preset shows recommended focal distance, effective f-stop, optimal pinhole diameter, and optimal f-stop.

25.9 FLASH GUIDE NUMBER CALCULATOR

Uses the guide number relationship (GN = Distance × Aperture) to find either the correct flash distance or the required aperture.

Mode:

- **Find Distance** — calculates how far the subject can be from the flash at a given aperture
- **Find Aperture** — calculates the required aperture at a given distance

Inputs:

- Guide Number (GN) — your flash's rated GN in metres or feet
- GN Reference ISO — the ISO at which the GN is rated (typically 100)
- Shooting ISO — actual shooting ISO (higher ISO increases effective GN)
- Flash Power — Full (1/1) through 1/128 in one-stop fractions
- Aperture (Find Distance mode) or Distance (Find Aperture mode)

Results show the effective GN after ISO and power adjustments, along with the final distance or aperture.

25.10 ROLLING SHUTTER CALCULATOR

Helps find the correct tension and aperture setting for focal-plane shutter cameras (Graflex SLRs, Speed Graphic press cameras).

Built-in camera profiles:

- Speed Graphic
- Auto Graflex 1 & 2
- R.B. Series BD
- R.B. Super D

You can add your own camera profiles as well.

Workflow:

1. Select your camera profile
2. Lock your exposure on the Meter tab — the target speed appears at the top of the calculator
3. The table highlights the nearest available tension/aperture combination in amber

Show on Meter: Enable to display the recommended tension and aperture slot directly on the main meter readout as a compact chip.

Badge colours:

- **Green** — exact (or very close) match
- **Amber** — approximation (+ = slightly faster than metered, − = slightly slower)
- **Grey** — closest match is more than ⅓ stop away

- **Bulb (amber)** — metered time is longer than the slowest speed in the table — use bulb mode

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25.11 CUSTOM SHUTTER SPEEDS

Save named presets of non-standard shutter speeds for mechanical cameras with vintage or non-standard click stops.

Creating a preset: Tap **+ Add Preset**, give it a name, then enter shutter speeds separated by commas or spaces. Use fractions (1/125) or decimals (0.5, 2). Duplicates are removed and speeds are sorted automatically.

Show on Meter: Enable to display a badge on the main meter screen showing the nearest speed from your preset to the currently calculated shutter speed.

Badge colours:

- **Green** — exact or very close match
- **Amber** — nearest available speed is within ⅓ stop (+ = faster than metered, − = slower)
- **Grey** — nearest match is more than ⅓ stop away

A custom shutter preset can be saved as part of a **Preferred Setup** for quick recall.

25.12 ZEBRA EXPOSURE GUIDE

Two Zebra Dry Plates-specific calculators:

Zebra Exposure Chart Calculator: Select month, time of day, lighting condition, aperture, and subject type to estimate exposure time using historical Zebra ISO 2 chart data.

In-Camera Test Strip Creator: Generates five exposure strips in a linear progression from a base value. Choose **Shutter** or **F-Stop** mode and a stop increment (⅓, ½, or full stop). The center strip (highlighted amber) is the base. In Shutter mode, cumulative add-times are shown so you can expose each strip sequentially in the darkroom.

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26. Gear Management & Customization

Access: Settings → **Gear Management**

This section covers every way to customize the dials, lists, and values that appear throughout the app.

26.1 FILM STOCKS

Access: Settings → Gear Management → **Film Stocks**

The film stock panel lists your active stock library. Three ways to add stocks:

Built-in stocks: The app ships with a curated set of common panchromatic, orthochromatic, and specialty stocks. They appear in the stock picker automatically.

Zebra Dry Plates Film Stocks: Tap this button to browse the full Zebra Dry Plates catalogue fetched from GitHub and cached locally for up to one hour. If the cache is missing or expired, an internet connection is needed to load the catalogue. Tap + next to any stock to add it to your local library. Stocks include dry plates, tintypes, and golden tintypes, all at ISO 2 with blue-sensitive spectral profiles. Custom formats defined in the CSV (via formatWidth/formatHeight columns) are automatically registered as custom film formats when you add the stock.

Popular Film Stocks: Tap this button to browse a curated list of commonly used third-party stocks (Kodak, Ilford, Fuji, etc.) and add them with one tap.

Adding a fully custom stock: Tap **+ Add Film Stock** to manually enter:

- Name
- ISO speed
- Spectral sensitivity (Panchromatic / Orthochromatic / Blue-Sensitive / Infrared / Cyanotype)
- Reciprocity profile (pick from existing profiles or leave none)
- Purchase URL (optional — shows a cart icon in the stock picker)
- Positive Exposure flag (auto-selects Dryplate Positive at +0.5 stop by default when this stock is selected)

Selecting and managing stocks: Tap any bundled or custom stock to select it. Copy a stock to create an editable custom copy, edit custom stocks, or remove any stock. To recover a removed bundled stock without changing your other settings, open **Removed bundled stocks** in the Film Stocks picker and tap **Restore** beside its name.

26.2 CUSTOM RECIPROCITY PROFILES

Access: Settings → Gear Management → Film Stocks → **+ Add Film Profile**

Add a reciprocity failure profile for any film not already in the list.

Inputs:

- **Name** — identifies the profile in the picker
- **p-factor (Schwarzschild exponent)** — typical range 1.1–1.5. Higher values mean more severe failure (more extra time needed). Examples:
  - Kodak T-Max 100: ~1.26
  - Ilford HP5: ~1.31
  - Fuji Provia 100F: ~1.33
  - Kodak Portra 400: ~1.22
  - Wet plate collodion: ~1.3–1.5 depending on formulation
- **Threshold (seconds)** — the exposure time below which no correction is applied (default 1 s for most films; some slow emulsions start earlier at 0.5 s)

Using the profile: Once saved it appears in the reciprocity profile picker for any film stock. You can also use it directly in the Reciprocity Calculator (Extra Tools) without linking it to a stock.

26.3 FOCAL LENGTHS (LENS DIAL)

Access: Settings → Gear Management → **Lenses**

Controls which focal lengths appear in the focal length selector on the Meter screen.

Enabling / disabling built-in focal lengths: Tap any focal length chip to toggle it on (filled) or off (outline). The chip turns amber when active. Disabled focal lengths are hidden from the selector — use this to keep the list uncluttered if you only shoot a few lenses.

Built-in focal lengths available: 8mm, 10mm, 14mm, 15mm, 17mm, 18mm, 20mm, 21mm, 24mm, 28mm, 35mm, 40mm, 45mm, 50mm, 55mm, 65mm, 75mm, 80mm, 85mm, 90mm, 100mm, 105mm, 110mm, 120mm, 127mm, 135mm, 150mm, 180mm, 210mm, 240mm, 300mm, 360mm, 400mm, 450mm, 600mm, 800mm

Adding a custom focal length: Tap **+ Custom Lens** and enter any focal length in mm (e.g. 58, 90, 165). Custom focal lengths appear in the lens dial alongside built-in values, sorted numerically. Use this for unusual LF lenses, vintage lenses, or any focal length not in the built-in list.

Removing a custom focal length: Tap the trash icon next to any custom focal length in the list. Built-in focal lengths cannot be permanently deleted — only toggled off.

How focal length affects the app:

- Drives the viewfinder frame line scale (field of view simulation)
- Used in bellows compensation formula (total draw ÷ focal length, where total draw = extra extension + focal length)
- Used in DoF calculations (hyperfocal distance, near/far limits)
- Determines which physical phone camera lens Auto Lens Selection picks

Personal Lens Catalog

Access: Settings → Gear Management → **Personal Lens Catalog**

Add, edit, or remove lenses by name; different lenses may share a focal length. Enter focal length in millimeters or inches. The app stores it in millimeters for calculations and saved data.

Coverage: Choose one method. Select the largest format the lens covers; it is then available for that format and every smaller supported format. Or enter an image-circle diameter in millimeters; formats whose diagonal fits within the circle are covered. Do not use both methods. Existing records, including older records with both or neither coverage value, remain importable. When editing a record with both values, choose which method to keep before saving.

Apertures: Enter the complete list of marked f-numbers separated by semicolons, such as **f/2.8; F4; 1:5.6**, or choose **Infer from four marks**. For inference, enter the largest and smallest marked f-numbers plus two additional marks. Review the generated-series preview. The four marks must be positive and distinct, and their spacing must fit a standard aperture series before saving.

Shutter: Choose **No shutter** or **Mechanical**. For a mechanical shutter, enter its marks separated by semicolons. Bare marks are reciprocal denominators: **1** = 1 second, **2** = 1/2 second, and **4** = 1/4 second. Add **s** for explicit seconds, as in **1/2s** or **2s**. You can also enter the number of unnumbered clicks between marks and review the preview. Ambiguous spacing must be clarified before saving. The meter stores speeds in seconds and uses the nearest supported speed for ideal times no longer than the slowest mark, showing the EV difference. For a longer ideal exposure, it displays the ideal duration so you can select Bulb on the camera. A no-shutter lens does not create a mechanical speed list; general shutter choices and any rolling-shutter match remain available.

UV glass: Choose a known glass type when available. Unknown glass does not receive an invented lens-specific factor. **Custom** glass requires a known UV-transmission percentage. Lens-specific UV compensation is used when UV compensation is enabled.

CSV import and export: Use the buttons in the catalog to import a validated CSV or share an export. The exported columns are

```
id,name,focal_length_mm,coverage_formats,image_circle_mm,aperture_marks,aperture_clicks_betw
```

`een_marks,shutter_capability,shutter_marks,shutter_clicks_between_marks,uv_glass_type,uv_transmission_pct`. New CSV files can provide focal length in millimeters or use the `focal_length_in` column; values are stored in millimeters. For format coverage, use one largest format key (or the legacy `coverage_formats` column); legacy lists with multiple keys remain readable. Alternatively, provide `image_circle_mm`. Do not provide both coverage methods. Older click-count aperture columns remain accepted for compatibility; exports contain the full usable aperture series unless a legacy click count must be preserved. Invalid rows are reported and not applied.

26.4 FILM FORMATS

Access: Settings → Gear Management → **Formats**

Controls which film formats appear in the format selector on the Meter screen.

Enabling / disabling built-in formats: Tap any format chip to toggle it on or off. Enabled formats appear in the format picker; disabled ones are hidden. Keeping only the formats you shoot makes the picker faster to navigate.

Built-in formats available:

FORMAT	FRAME SIZE
35mm	24×36 mm
35mm Half Frame	18×24 mm
6×4.5	56×42 mm
6×6	56×56 mm
6×7	56×70 mm
6×9	56×84 mm
6×12	56×112 mm
6×17	56×170 mm
4×5 in	95×119 mm
5×7 in	127×178 mm
8×10 in	203×254 mm
11×14 in	279×356 mm
Instax Mini	46×62 mm
Instax Wide	62×99 mm
Instax Square	62×62 mm
110	13×17 mm
126	28×28 mm
127 (4×4)	40×40 mm
Disk	8×11 mm
APS-C	25×17 mm

Adding a custom format: Tap **+ Custom Format**, enter:

- **Name** — what appears in the format picker (e.g. "9×12 cm")
- **Width** (mm) — short dimension of the frame
- **Height** (mm) — long dimension of the frame

The app derives the aspect ratio and viewfinder framing automatically. Custom formats also drive DoF calculations with a circle of confusion derived from the diagonal.

Removing a custom format: Tap the trash icon next to any custom format. Built-in formats cannot be permanently deleted — only toggled off.

How format affects the app:

- Sets the viewfinder frame line aspect ratio
- Sets the circle of confusion for DoF calculations
- Used in the Equivalent Lens Calculator (crop factor)
- Used in the Pinhole Calculator (image circle coverage)

26.5 APERTURES (F-STOP DIAL)

Access: Settings → Gear Management → **Apertures**

Controls which f-stops appear in the aperture selector on the Meter screen.

Enabling / disabling built-in f-stops: Tap any aperture chip to toggle it on or off. Disabled values are hidden from the selector. Use this to keep the list clean — for example, disable f/6.7 and f/9.5 if you never use non-standard LF lens apertures.

When you change Stop Increment (Settings → Metering → Stop Increment): new standard values for the newly selected increment are automatically merged into your active aperture set. For example, switching from full stops to ⅓ stops adds f/1.1, f/1.2, f/1.4 (⅓-stop steps between f/1 and f/1.4), etc.

Activating multiple stop increments simultaneously: Tap multiple stop increment options to activate more than one at once (e.g. both ⅓ stop and Full stop). The aperture and shutter speed selectors merge and deduplicate values from all active sets, sorted numerically. Snapping finds the nearest value across the combined list.

Adding a custom aperture: Tap **+ Custom Aperture** and enter any f-number (e.g. 6.3, 9.5, 4.5). Useful for:

- Large format lenses with non-standard aperture markings (e.g. f/6.3, f/11.3)
- Older lenses with Continental stop series (f/3.5, f/4.5, f/6.3, f/9, f/12.5)
- Pinhole cameras where you've calculated an effective f-stop
- Any lens with a maximum aperture that falls between standard values (e.g. f/1.2 on a fast 50)

Removing a custom aperture: Tap the chip in the custom apertures row to remove it. Built-in apertures cannot be permanently deleted — only toggled off.

26.6 CUSTOM ISO VALUES

Access: Settings → Metering → **Custom ISO**

Add non-standard ISO values not on the built-in dial.

Adding a custom ISO: Tap **+ Add ISO** and enter any value. Supports:

- Integers (e.g. 12, 400, 3200)
- Decimals (e.g. **0.3** for wet plate collodion, **5.3** for Zebra Dry Plates, **25.6** for some glass plates)
- Values below 1 are fully supported — useful for extremely slow processes

Custom values are merged with the standard ISO list, deduplicated, and sorted. They appear on the ISO dial alongside the built-in values.

Removing a custom ISO: Tap the chip in the custom ISO row to remove it.

ISO and film stock interaction: When you manually change the ISO dial after selecting a film stock, the stock is deselected and your manual ISO takes over. To return to stock-native ISO, reselect the film stock from the picker.

26.7 PREFERRED SETUPS

Create, edit, and delete named setting combinations — see Section 14 for full details.

26.8 VIEWFINDER CALIBRATION

Access: Settings → Viewfinder → **Viewfinder Calibration**

Fine-tunes viewfinder framing separately from light meter calibration. The app uses reported field-of-view data for individually exposed phone camera lenses when available. Logical multi-camera devices and missing camera data retain approximate framing. The fallback phone camera lens estimates are:

LENS	DEFAULT EQUIVALENT FL
Ultra-wide (iOS)	~13 mm
Main / Standard	~26 mm
Telephoto (iOS)	~77 mm
Android wide	~26 mm

The 26 mm reset value is the neutral manual adjustment for automatic framing. Increasing the calibration value widens the view; decreasing it tightens the view. Compare recognizable scene landmarks with your camera at the same viewpoint before adjusting.

To calibrate: Use the – / + buttons to step the value in 1 mm increments. Hardware zoom limits can still prevent the requested framing.

27. App Tools Configuration

Access: Settings → Preferences → **App Tools Configuration**

Show or hide optional features to keep the interface focused on what you use.

SETTINGS FEATURES (SHOWN/HIDDEN FROM THE SETTINGS TAB)

FEATURE	WHAT IT CONTROLS
Spectral Sensitivity	Film-type spectral corrections
Positive Exposure	Adjustable Dryplate Positive or Paper Reversal compensation
Environmental Compensation	UV/altitude corrections
RA4 Color Reversal	Filter pack suggestions
IR Light Estimator	Infrared exposure guidance
Viewfinder Zoom Slider	Left-edge focal length slider
UV Lens Coating	Scale UV compensation by lens coating type

EXTRA TOOLS (SHOWN/HIDDEN FROM THE EXTRA TOOLS TAB)

TOOL	NOTES
Zebra Exposure Guide	Always visible
Depth of Field Calculator	Always visible
Alternative Processes Meter	Always visible
Wet Plate Timer	Always visible
Step Wedge Tool	Always visible
Rolling Shutter Calculator	Always visible
Reciprocity Calculator	Always visible
Equivalent Lens Calculator	Always visible
Pinhole Calculator	Always visible
Flash GN Calculator	Always visible
Custom Shutter Speeds	Always visible

When all Extra Tools are hidden, the Extra Tools tab shows an empty state prompt.

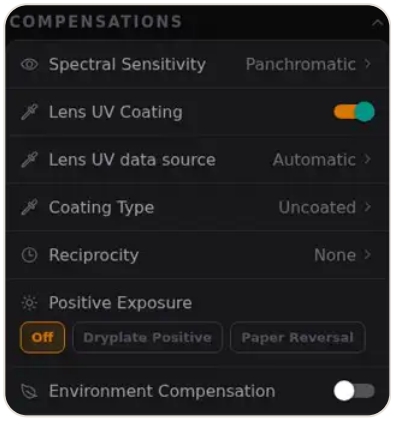
All toggles default to on. Changes take effect instantly and persist across app restarts.

28. Settings Reference

These genuine captures show the seeded web preview. Values and toggle states are examples and may differ from your saved settings.

COMPENSATIONS SECTION

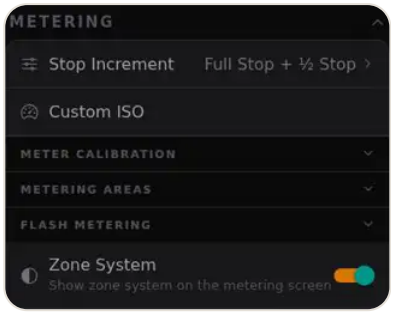
SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Spectral Sensitivity	Panchromatic / Orthochromatic / Blue-Sensitive
Positive Exposure	Adjustable Dryplate Positive or Paper Reversal compensation
Environmental Compensation	Auto UV/altitude from GPS
Bellows Compensation	Macro/LF extension penalty
Manual Exposure Compensation	±EV offset applied to all readings



(Example) Compensations settings.

METERING SECTION

SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Stop Increment	⅓ stop, ½ stop, ⅔ stop, full stop (can activate multiple simultaneously)
Spot Metering Size	Controls the radius of the spot circle (small = pinpoint, large = wider spot)
Center-Weighted Size	How much of the centre is prioritised vs. the edges
Average Metering Size	100% = full frame; lower = centre-biased average
Multi-Point Metering	Enable averaged 2–4 point readings
Custom ISO	Add non-standard ISO values including decimals
Flash Trigger	Off / Optical Slave (LED) / Cable Sync (3.5mm) / Light Sensor (Android)
Torch Duration	LED burst length for Optical Slave mode: 50 ms / 100 ms / 150 ms (default) / 200 ms
Flash Sensitivity	Maximum / High / Normal (default) / Reduced / Low / Minimum — see Section 11
Metering Priority	Speed responds faster with less preview flicker and is the default; Quality waits longer for AE/AF settling and may cause more preview flicker. Try Quality for a static scene when you want a longer settling window
Flash Duration	Assumed strobe burst length (t0.1) for EV deconvolution: 0.5–15 ms (4 ms default) — see Section 11

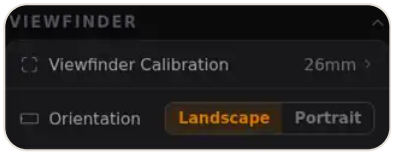


(Example) Metering settings.

SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Flash EV Trim	Flash-only offset, ±2 EV in one-third-stop steps while flash mode is active — see Section 11
Calibrate Light Meter	Two-point calibration wizard (per camera/lens combination)

VIEWFINDER SECTION

SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Camera Lens	Ultra-wide / Main / Telephoto (iOS)
Auto-select Camera Lens	Automatic lens switching by focal length
Zoom Slider	Enable/disable focal length slider
Viewfinder Calibration	Per-lens viewfinder calibration
Viewfinder Margin	Inner frame line margin (0–20%)
Orientation	Portrait / Landscape simulated film frame
Allow Screen Rotation	Enable landscape metering by rotating the phone
Landscape Controls	Place the landscape control panel on the left or right



(Example) Viewfinder settings.

GEAR MANAGEMENT

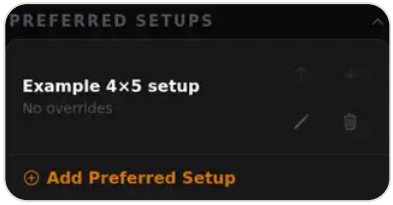
Manage lens and personal lens catalogs, apertures, film formats, film stocks, and filters used by the meter.



(Example) Gear Management settings.

PREFERRED SETUPS

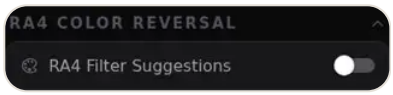
Save reusable setups, then add, edit, reorder, or delete them. The example shown is sample data for this capture.



(Example) Preferred Setups.

RA4 COLOR REVERSAL

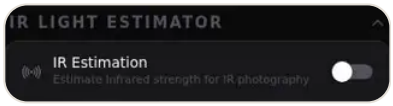
Enable RA4 filter suggestions and configure related paper, filter, and light-source choices when using the optional RA4 workflow.



(Example) RA4 Color Reversal settings.

IR LIGHT ESTIMATOR

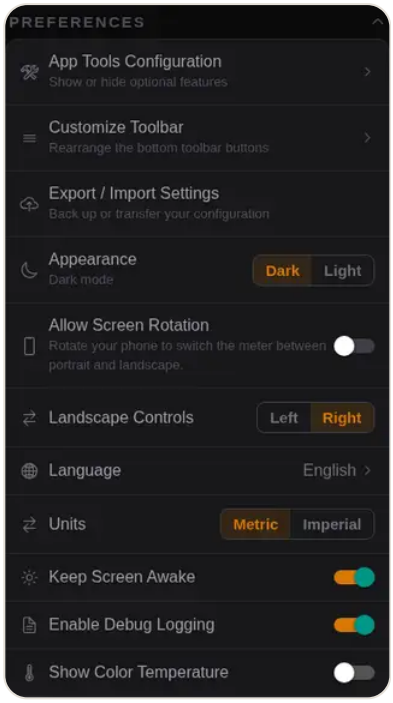
Enable IR estimation for infrared photography. This section is available when the optional tool is enabled or infrared sensitivity is selected.



(Example) IR Light Estimator settings.

PREFERENCES SECTION

SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Units	Metric / Imperial
Language	English / Slovenian / Spanish / French / German / Japanese / Chinese Simplified
Keep Screen Awake	Prevents sleep during metering
Auto-save to Gallery	Saves each new journal photo to the ProFilm Meter album automatically (iOS/Android)
Show Color Temperature	Live Kelvin badge on viewfinder
Debug Logging	Detailed internal logs for bug reports
App Tools Configuration	Show/hide optional features
Theme	Dark / Light



(Example) Preferences settings.

ABOUT SECTION

- App version and build number
- Website link
- Report a Bug (opens native email compose)
- Debug Log (view / copy / clear internal logs)
- Factory Reset — erases ALL data (saved exposures, calibration, custom stocks, settings). **This cannot be undone.**

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29. Settings Transfer

Access: Settings → **Export / Import Settings**

Export selected categories of settings to a **.profilm** file and import them on the same or another device. Film gear settings include the Personal Lens Catalog and the selected lens. Preferred Setups include the catalog lenses they reference so imported setups remain usable.

Included RA4 and filter data: Compensations preserves RA4 paper selection and configuration, custom and remote filter catalog metadata, available filter IDs, filter preferences and selection, base-filter and on-lens state, UV filter, and light source. Custom Film Stocks preserves custom films and calibrated RA4 papers, plus IDs of removed bundled stocks. Preferred Setups also bundles only referenced custom stocks and filters.

Export: Choose the categories, tap **Export Settings**, and save or share the .profilm file.

Import: Choose a .profilm file, select the categories to restore, and confirm. The complete selected payload is validated before anything is written; malformed or incompatible files are rejected without changing saved settings. Journal entries, photos, and device-specific camera or meter calibration are excluded.

30. Troubleshooting

BLANK OR DARK VIEWFINDER

- Ensure camera permission is granted in your device's Settings → Privacy → Camera
- Try switching camera lenses in Settings → Viewfinder → Camera Lens
- Restart the app if the camera feed is frozen unexpectedly

SW BADGE APPEARING CONSTANTLY

The **SW** badge means the app is using software EV estimation rather than raw camera EXIF. This is normal briefly during startup or lens switching. If it persists, try re-calibrating via Settings → Metering → Calibrate Light Meter.

EXPORT FAILS SILENTLY

- Ensure media library permission is granted (Settings → Privacy → Photos)
- If the image hasn't fully loaded before export, the app will wait and display a message
- If the image file was deleted or moved since saving, the app will show a specific "file not found" error

CALIBRATION GATE BLOCKING THE VIEWFINDER

The calibration gate appears when the active camera has not been calibrated. Tap **Calibrate Now** to run the two-point calibration wizard. After calibrating each lens, the gate will not reappear for that lens.

FLASH NOT DETECTED

- For Optical Slave mode, point the phone toward the flash unit's optical sensor window
- Lower **Flash Sensitivity** (Settings → Metering → Flash Sensitivity) toward Maximum or High if the flash isn't registering
- Raise it toward Reduced or Low if you are getting false triggers from ambient light changes
- After changing sensitivity, **re-arm the flash** for the new setting to take effect

RECIPROCITY CORRECTION NOT SHOWING

The corrected time only appears after you **Lock** the exposure. During live metering, the raw calculated time is always shown. Lock first to see the correction.

JOURNAL PHOTOS NOT EXPORTING CORRECTLY (IOS)

After an iOS app update, the image file path may have changed. The app automatically normalises stored file paths on startup — if an entry still shows a blank photo, delete and re-save that reading.

ProFilm Meter is developed in collaboration between Scott Henderson Photography and Zebra Dry Plates. All metering and analysis runs entirely on-device — no data is collected, transmitted, or stored on external servers.

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